

Chapter 7 Test— Answer Key

Multiple Choice [Each correct answer is worth 1 point.]

Circle the correct answer(s) from the choices below. Some will have more than one answer.

1. According to Charles Spurgeon, Christians . . .
 - a. should be ashamed of doubt.
 - b. only doubt if they are weak.
 - c. are sinning if they doubt.
 - d. all doubt sometimes.**
2. When Thomas doubted, Jesus . . .
 - a. responded with a stern scolding.
 - b. was disappointed in him.
 - c. answered by giving Thomas himself.**
 - d. blessed those who would believe without being direct eyewitnesses.**
 - e. wept over the state of unbelief among the disciples.
 - f. blessed the other disciples for being strong in their faith.
3. A process in which previously accepted beliefs are dismantled is called . . .
 - a. faith reconstruction.
 - b. untangling.
 - c. restoration.
 - d. faith deconstruction.**
 - e. dissonance.
4. Doubt may arise because . . .
 - a. we lack proper knowledge or understanding.**
 - b. we think Christianity lacks intellectual muscle or credibility.**
 - c. we believe Christianity is unreasonable or emotionally manipulative.**
 - d. we are not given adequate answers to our questions or are told not to ask.**
 - e. we find once-persuasive arguments to be faulty or inadequate to sustain faith.**
 - f. we don't work hard enough to keep our spiritual highs.
5. Choose all that are true about emotions.
 - a. Emotions are not infallible and can be misleading.**
 - b. Emotions are not important and should be contained or avoided.
 - c. Emotions can indicate something important and invite us deeper into an experience.**
 - d. Emotions are part of the *imago Dei*, as all Persons of the Trinity display emotions.**
 - e. Emotions demonstrate how close we are to God and how strong our faith is.
 - f. Emotions tell us who we really are and how to understand reality.
 - g. Emotions can play a role in why we experience doubt.**

6. When dealing with emotional doubt, it can help to . . .
 - a. **rest our minds.**
 - b. **take care of our physical health.**
 - c. question everything until we feel satisfied.
 - d. **remind ourselves of what we know to be true.**
 - e. try to have a mountaintop experience.
 - f. make decisions about discarding or keeping our beliefs.

7. Experiential doubt . . .
 - a. is a failure to pay attention to the arguments for the truth of Christianity.
 - b. **is about how different experiences affect our perception of what is true.**
 - c. **may occur if a person has only known legalistic or judgmental Christians.**
 - d. **may occur if a person has gone through a major loss or trauma.**
 - e. may occur if a person goes through a mountaintop experience.
 - f. **may occur if a person experiences cognitive dissonance where personal experiences seem to conflict with knowledge of God's character.**

8. Which key verse provides a definition of faith?
 - a. John 20:29
 - b. **Hebrews 11:1**
 - c. Mark 9:23–24
 - d. Jude 1:22

9. When dealing with trauma . . .
 - a. **it's important to seek professional help.**
 - b. it's important to avoid thinking too much about the event.
 - c. **it's helpful to focus on spiritual truths and Scriptures that promote healing.**
 - d. it's helpful to have someone review dogmas of the Christian faith.
 - e. it's helpful to process through the situation in isolation and solitude.

10. Choose all that are true about the New Testament passage called *the hall of faith*.
 - a. The hall of faith is in John 20.
 - b. **The hall of faith is in Hebrews 11.**
 - c. The hall of faith only includes people who never wavered in faith.
 - d. **The hall of faith includes people who struggled with doubt.**
 - e. **The hall of faith includes flawed people who trusted God.**

11. Which of these appropriately describes the moral dimension of faith?
 - a. **What we believe about God influences our ability to trust and obey.**
 - b. **Biblical faith produces righteous action.**
 - c. **Biblical faith cannot be condensed to merely having correct beliefs.**
 - d. What we believe about God should be carefully examined to see if it is true.

12. Biblical faith is . . .
 - a. belief without good reasons or evidence.
 - b. old-fashioned superstition and resistance to progress.
 - c. blind trust in something known to be untrue.
 - d. based on knowledge and evidence.**
 - e. the assurance of things hoped for, the conviction of things not seen.**
13. Some reasons people deconstruct their faith include . . .
 - a. an experience of shame or abuse in the church.**
 - b. coming to believe that Christianity promotes violence or prejudice.**
 - c. intellectual arguments against Christianity that seem compelling.**
 - d. none of the above
14. Choose all that are true of faith reconstruction.
 - a. It is an alternative to permanent faith deconstruction**
 - b. It is a way of leaving the faith.
 - c. It is rebuilding faith on a solid foundation instead of leaving it.**
 - d. It is building a version of Christianity customized to your desires.
15. Learning to carefully examine and submit all our beliefs to Jesus is . . .
 - a. a method for avoiding doubt and spiritual lows.
 - b. not necessary unless someone is facing a crisis.
 - c. something that happens automatically during justification.
 - d. an essential part of Christian discipleship.**
 - e. most people's response to cognitive dissonance.
16. Scripture urges us to meditate on God's truth, because . . .
 - a. that way we will not struggle with doubts.
 - b. otherwise we may struggle with forgetting God and falling into sin.**
 - c. we may earn God's favor by learning Bible verses.
 - d. that way we can convince agnostics to stop doubting.

True or False [Each question is worth 1 point.]

Indicate if each statement is true or false. If the statement is false, change the underlined word to make it true.

F 17. Faith deconstruction means an internal conflict arising from incompatibility between two different beliefs or between beliefs and actions. _____ **cognitive**
dissonance _____

F 18. Doubt refers to an extreme emotional response arising from a stressful, disturbing, or psychologically damaging event. _____ **trauma** _____

T 19. Practical atheism refers to believing in the existence of God but living as if he doesn't exist and is a form of cognitive dissonance.

T 20. Fear is a prominent emotion that causes doubt. _____

F 21. When a celebrity claims to be a Christian, but lives in unrepentant sin, this demonstrates experiential doubt. _____ practical atheism

T 22. In Jude 1:22, Christians are instructed to have mercy on those who doubt.

T 23. Only the reality of Christ can bring people to faith in spite of their doubts.

Fill-in-the-blank [Each answer is worth 2 points.]

Fill in the missing word to complete each statement.

24. The _____ church _____ needs to act as a community of Christians who are committed to Jesus, honest about their doubts, willing to explore, and ready to walk alongside those who are doubting.

25. _____ Faith _____ is trust in and allegiance to someone or something.

26. Doubts that occur during a difficult season or just after a spiritual high are an example of _____ emotional _____ doubt.

27. During times of fear or emotional doubt, _____ Satan _____ tries to discourage us, shame us, or get us to abandon our relationship with Jesus.

28. In _____ John 20:29 _____, Jesus said to Thomas, "Have you believed because you have seen me? Blessed are those who have not seen and yet have believed."

29. If Christians persistently choose to live against God and his ways, _____ doubt _____ is inevitable and abandoning Christianity is possible.

Short Answer [Each question is worth 3 points.]

Answer the following questions using complete sentences.

30. Name the five dimensions of biblical faith.

Spiritual, intellectual, physical and emotional, moral, and practical

31. Explain the opposite of faith.

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The opposite of faith is unbelief, especially stubborn unbelief. Stubborn unbelief is the unwillingness to believe even when presented with compelling evidence.

32. List three things to remember when shaken by intellectual doubts.

Christianity is not upheld by any single argument. When in doubt, we need to courageously investigate Christianity and our own beliefs. Our faith depends on Jesus, not on our personal intellectual knowledge or ability to defend Christianity.

33. What is the difference between doubt and unbelief?

Doubt is a feeling of uncertainty that may be caused by difficult experiences, changing emotions, or intellectual questions. Unbelief is a state of rejection and even stubborn unwillingness to believe when there are good reasons to do so.

Essay [Each question is worth 5 points.]

Answer the following questions with at least one paragraph.

34. Explain how faith deconstruction could result in leaving Christianity or in faith reconstruction. What do you think might cause a person to choose one direction or the other?

Possible answer: Faith deconstruction could end in abandoning Christianity if someone stays in an endless cycle of doubt. Some doubts may never be fully satisfied. A person who cannot accept this may leave Christianity and replace it with something else. Faith deconstruction can end in faith reconstruction if someone is willing to discard unbiblical and inaccurate beliefs so as to rebuild them on a firm biblical foundation. A person's priorities may be a factor in determining the outcome of his or her doubts. For example, if someone's main priority is to find the truth and realign their beliefs with Scripture, he or she may reconstruct his or her faith. If someone's main priority is being accepted by culture and continuing in a favorite sin, that person may abandon Christianity.

35. Create an analogy to explain biblical faith to a skeptic.

Possible answer: Biblical faith is like the faith placed in a family member, such as a parent. A reasonable person can have good reasons to know that his or her mother exists, can have a relationship with her, and can know her character through experience and other evidence.

This isn't a blind faith, it's trust. In a similar way, the Christian definition of faith is trust in a God we have good reasons to believe exists, can have relationship with, and whose character we can know through experience and other evidence.